

027. Chapter 3 Verses 1-3

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.1

अर्जुन उवाच ।
ज्यायसी चेत्कर्मणस्ते मता बुद्धिर्जनार्दन ।
तत्किं कर्मणि घोरे मां नियोजयसि केशव ॥ १ ॥

arjuna uvāca |
jyāyasī cetkarmaṇaste
matā buddhirjanārdana |
tatkiṃ karmaṇi ghore mām
niyojayasi keśava ||

- ◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;
- ◆ **jyāyasī** – superior; **cet** – if; **karmaṇaḥ** – than action; **te** – by You;
- ◆ **matā** – thought; **buddhiḥ** – intellect/wisdom; **janārdana** – O Janardana;
- ◆ **tat** – then; **kim** – why; **karmaṇi** – in action; **ghore** – ghastly/terrible; **mām** – me;
- ◆ **niyojayasi** – You engage; **keśava** – O Kesava.

Arjuna said: O Krishna! If your belief is that knowledge is superior to action, then why do you engage me in this dreadful act of battle?

VERSE 3.2

व्यामिश्रेणेव वाक्येन बुद्धिं मोहयसीव मे ।
तदेकं वद निश्चित्य येन श्रेयोऽहमाप्नुयाम् ॥ २ ॥

vyāmiśreṇeva vākyena
buddhiṃ mohayasīva me |
tadekaṃ vada niścitya
yena śreya'hamāpnuyām ||

- ◆ **vyāmiśreṇa** – equivocal/confusing; **iva** – as if; **vākyena** – by words;
- ◆ **buddhiṃ** – intellect; **mohyasi** – You confuse; **iva** – as it were; **me** – my;
- ◆ **tat** – that; **ekam** – one; **vada** – tell; **niścitya** – decisively;
- ◆ **yena** – by which; **śreyaḥ** – the highest good; **aham** – I; **āpnuyām** – may attain.

With these apparently contradictory words, You seem to confuse my understanding. Therefore tell me definitely that one thing by which I shall reach the Highest Goal.

VERSE 3.3

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
लोकेऽस्मिन्द्विविधा निष्ठा पुरा प्रोक्ता मया नघ ।
ज्ञानयोगेन साङ्ख्यानां कर्मयोगेन योगिनाम् ॥ ३ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
loke'smindvividhā niṣṭhā
purā proktā mayānagha |
jñānayogena sāṅkhyānām
karmayogena yoginām ||

- ◆ **śrī-bhagavān uvāca** – The Blessed Lord said;
- ◆ **loke** – in the world; **asmin** – in this; **dvividhā** – two-fold; **niṣṭhā** – path/discipline;
- ◆ **purā** – formerly; **proktā** – was declared; **mayā** – by Me; **anagha** – O sinless one;
- ◆ **jñāna-yogena** – by the path of Knowledge; **sāṅkhyānām** – for the Sankhyas; **karma-yogena** – by the path of Action; **yoginām** – for the Yogis.

The Blessed Lord said: O sinless Arjuna! In ancient times two paths of spiritual description were spoken by me – the Jnana yoga for the followers of the path of knowledge, and Karma yoga for the followers of the path of action.